

BRIDGE

Setu Bandhasana

Bridge is a gentle and accessible backbend that can help relieve back pain, particularly discomfort caused by sitting down too much. It is a calming pose, used by many to wind down at the end of a practice or at the end of the day in preparation for sleep.

THE BIG PICTURE

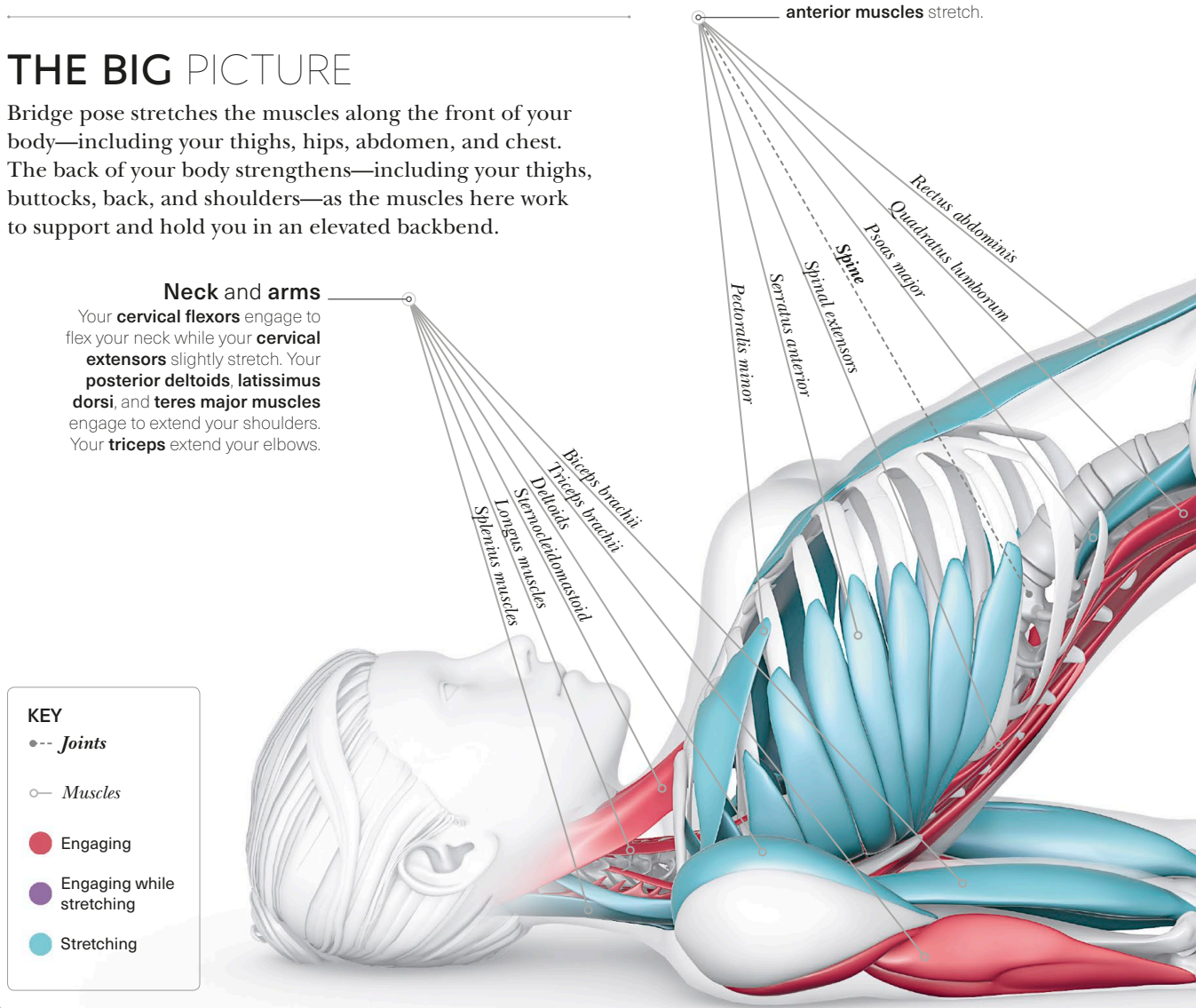
Bridge pose stretches the muscles along the front of your body—including your thighs, hips, abdomen, and chest. The back of your body strengthens—including your thighs, buttocks, back, and shoulders—as the muscles here work to support and hold you in an elevated backbend.

Neck and arms

Your **cervical flexors** engage to flex your neck while your **cervical extensors** slightly stretch. Your **posterior deltoids, latissimus dorsi, and teres major** muscles engage to extend your shoulders. Your **triceps** extend your elbows.

Torso

Your **spinal extensors** engage while your **abdominals** stretch. Your **pectorals**—particularly your **pectoralis minor** muscles—stretch as you broaden your chest. Your **middle and lower trapezius** work with the **rhomboids** to retract and stabilize your scapulae, while your **serratus anterior** muscles stretch.



KEY

--- Joints

— Muscles

● Engaging

● Engaging while stretching

● Stretching